PP-B-2016A
September 27, 1978
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PP-B-002016(Army-GL)
July 19, 1977 and
MIL-B-35032C
28 June 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# BACON, SLICED, PRECOOKED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sliced precooked bacon for use by agencies of the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 The product shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Non-refrigerated (canned)
Type II - Frozen (flexibly packaged)

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| L-P-378 | - | Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin |
| PP-B-81 | - | Bacon Slab or Sliced, Chilled or Frozen |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard |
| PPP-B-1163 | - | Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated |
| PPP-C-29 | - | Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing Of |

FSC 8905

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Federal Standards:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| FED-STD-101 | - | Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials; Test Procedures |
| FED-STD-123 | - | Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies) |

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-L-1497 | - | Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items |

Military Standards:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |
| MIL-STD-129 | - | Marking for Shipment and Storage |
| MIL-STD-414 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Variables for Percent Defective |
| MIL-STD-668 | - | Sanitary Standards for Food Plants |

(Copies of Military Specifications, Standards, Drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

US Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder



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US Department of Agriculture

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

US Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Food Safety and Quality Service, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified the supplier shall furnish samples for first article inspection and approval (see 4.1.2, 6.5 and 6.6).



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3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Bacon slab material. The cured and smoked bacon slabs used to produce type I and II precooked bacon slices shall be produced in conformance with the requirements of PP-B-81 and shall comply with the end item requirements of type II, form A, class 1 product with the following exceptions:

1. The bacon slabs may be formed or unformed.
2. The bacon slab width requirement shall not apply.
3. The bacon slab salt and moisture content requirements shall apply only for bacon slabs used to produce type II precooked bacon slabs.
4. Packaging, packing and movement of slabs between plants shall be in accordance with Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations.

3.2.2 Other materials. All other materials, frying fat, antioxidants, etc. shall be as permitted in the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the US Department of Agriculture. Frying fat, if used, shall be rendered pork fat or hydrogenated vegetable fat or oil with or without antioxidants. All materials shall be free from off flavors, off odors and foreign material (see 4.3.3.2).

3.3 Preparation.

3.3.1 Slicing. The bacon slabs meeting the requirements of 3.2.1 shall be mechanically cut into slices so that the slice count shall be 16 to 22 slices per pound (0.45 kg) and the slice count of the finished product shall meet the minimum slice counts specified in 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as applicable.

3.3.2 Precooking. Precooking may be accomplished by any recognized commercial method to obtain uniform, untangled slices having a natural cooked bacon color, taste and odor that will comply with 3.4. Sliced bacon shall be cooked sufficiently so that the yield of cooked bacon from the cooker shall not exceed 40 percent of the weight of the bacon entering the cooker (see 4.5.2).

3.3.3 Records of processing times and temperature shall be maintained.

3.4 Finished precooked bacon slices. The finished precooked bacon slices shall comply with the following physical requirements.



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TABLE I. Requirements for precooked bacon slices

| Item No. | Requirements |
|---|---|
| 1 | Not more than 10 percent of the slices shall have burnt edges or burnt areas larger than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension (see 6.8 and table IV). |
| 2 | Not more than 5 percent of the slices shall be brittle (see 6.8 and table IV). |
| 3 | Not more than 5 percent of the slices shall be cut or torn (see 6.8 and table IV). 1/ |
| 4 | Not more than 5 percent of the slices shall contain buttons, bones, or feather bones. |
| 5 | No slice shall contain a bruise in excess of 1/2 inch (13 mm) in any dimension. |
| 6 | No slice shall possess a foreign or undesirable flavor. |
| 7 | All slices shall be free of foreign material (see 6.8). |

1/ Slices where portions of the fat have cooked away leaving an apparent tear or cut shall not be considered cut or torn slices.

3.4.1 Freezing (type II only). After the filled packages have been sealed (see 5.1.2), they shall be placed in a blast freezer or other freezing apparatus operated at -20°F (-29°C) or lower within 4 hours from the time the slices are removed from the cooking process. The product shall be frozen and stored at an internal temperature of 0°F (-18°C) or lower.

3.4.2 Chemical requirements (type I only). The moisture to salt ratio (see 6.8) shall not exceed 9.0 (unit value).

3.4.3 Temperature of type II product at time of shipment and delivery. The temperature at time of shipment and delivery shall not exceed 0°F (-18°C).

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall originate and be processed, marked and handled in plants which are operated under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the US Department of Agriculture. Finished product refrigeration facilities (freezer, storage and shipping) not operating under these regulations shall meet the requirements of MIL-STD-668.



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## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless diapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(1) Pre-acceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection) see 4.3.
(2) First article inspection (see 4.2.1).
(3) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.3).

4.2.1 First article inspection. First article samples of product which the supplier intends to supply shall be inspected to assure compliance with 3.4.

4.2.2 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.3 Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.6.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the US Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for military agencies (see 4.3.4)).

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.



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4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.3.1 Examination of slab bacon material. Examination of the slab bacon material shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.2.1 and exceptions specified, as applicable. Examination shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of PP-B-81, as applicable, for the material, processing, and end item requirements for type II, form A, class I product. Nonconformance to acceptance criteria, or use of component failing to meet acceptance criteria, shall be cause for rejection of the involved lot or product made therefrom. When authorized (see 6.1), the contractor or his authorized representative shall furnish the Quality Assurance Representative (QAR) a Certificate of Conformance (COC), certifying conformance of the finished slab bacon material to the applicable requirements of 3.2.1 in lieu of actual examination results or records.

4.3.3.2 Examination of other materials. Examination of other materials shall be made to determine compliance with the identity and condition requirements of 3.2.2. Determination of compliance to identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. In addition, examination shall be made to determine compliance to condition requirements. The sample for examination shall be a 1 pound (0.45 kg) composite derived equally from five primary containers or all the containers if less than five form a lot. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the sample lot or finished product made therefrom. When foreign material is found during the examination, the lot shall be referred to the US Department of Agriculture Inspector for disposition in compliance with inspection criteria of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the US Department of Agriculture.

4.3.3.3 Testing of components. Testing of components described in this specification and changes listed in subsidiary specifications shall be as shown in table II. Requirements for test characteristics shall be applicable to the lot average. Nonconformance to one or more of the test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.



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TABLE II. Testing of components 1/ (see 4.3.3)

| Component | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | Inspection level | Characteristics | Results reported to nearest | Test ref & rqmt para |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Vegetable parchment or parchmentized paper | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) | No. of reams | S-1 | Basis weight | lb/ream ($g/m^2$) | 4.5.2.3 5.1.1 |
| Kraft or sulfite paperboard | Boards | No. of boards | S-1 | Thickness | 0.001 inch (.01 mm) | 5.1.2 |
| Polyethylene coating | Boards | No. of boards | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (.0001 mm) | 5.1.2 |
| Package base mat'l i.e., polyethylene | Boards | No. of packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.001 inch (0.01 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(a) |
| Polymer coated polyamide | Packages | No. of packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(a) |
| Covering material: Polyethylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.001 inch (0.01 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(a) |
| Polymer polyester | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(a) |
| Polymer coating | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(a) |



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TABLE II. Testing of components 1/ (see 4.3.3) (cont'd)

| Component | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | Inspection level | Characteristics | Results reported to nearest | Test ref & rqmt para |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Film: Polymer coated polyester | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(b) |
| Film: Polyethylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.001 inch (0.01 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(b) |
| Polymer coating | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(b) |
| Polyethylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(c) |
| Polypropylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(c) |
| Polyethylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Basis weight | lbs per ream (g/$m^2$) | 4.5.2.3 5.1.2.1(c) |
| Polymer coating | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) or one package | Yards (m) or packages | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(c) |
| Polyethylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 m2) | Yards (m) | S-1 | Thickness | 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(d) |



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TABLE II. Testing of components 1/ (see 4.3.3) (cont'd)

| Component | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | Inspection level | Characteristics | Results reported to nearest | Test ref & rqmt para |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Film: Polymer coated polypropylene | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) | Yards (m) | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(d) |
| Polymer coating | 1/2 sq yd (0.42 $m^2$) | Yards (m) | S-1 | Thickness | 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.5.2.4 5.1.2.1(d) |

1/ In lieu of performing tests for thickness of each lamina, condition and identity requirements of the adhesive, conformance to requirements may be ascertained by examination of labels or other valid documents. Nonconformance to one or more requirement(s) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.4 In-process examination. Examination shall be made during processing to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.3 and 3.4.1 and vacuum requirements of 5.1.2 as follows: For slicing and precooking requirements of 3.3 and vacuum requirements of 5.1.2 by observation; for time and temperature requirements of 3.4.1 by examination of refrigeration time and temperature records. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the component lot or the finished product made therefrom. When foreign material is found during the examination, the lot shall be referred to the US Department of Agriculture Inspector for disposition in compliance with inspection criteria of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the US Department of Agriculture.

4.3.4 Examination of the end item. Classification of defects during examination shall be in accordance with table IV through VII and 4.3.4.1 through 4.3.4.4. The examination criteria for table IV through VII shall be as shown in table III. AQLs shall be expressed as percent defective for tables IV and V and as defects per hundred units for tables VI and VII.



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TABLE III. End item examination criteria

| Table | Inspection level | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | AQLs Major B | AQLs Minor |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| IV | S-3 | Contents of one primary container | No. of primary containers | -- | 2.5 |
| V | S-3 | Contents of one primary container | No. of primary containers | -- | 6.5 |
| VI | S-3 | Contents of one primary container | No. of primary containers | 4.0 | 6.5 |
| VII | S-3 | One primary container | No. of primary containers | 2.5 | 6.5 |

TABLE IV. Examination for net weight 1/

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Minor | Type I |
| 201 | Net weight less than 21-3/4 ounces (617 g). 2/ 3/ |
| | Type II |
| 202 | Net weight less than 31-1/2 ounces (893 g). 2/ 3/ |

1/ Weigh container and wrapper or separator and contents and record gross weight. Weigh a representative unused container and wrapper or separator from the component lot for tare. To obtain the net weight, subtract the tare weight from the gross weight.

2/ Weigh to a tolerance of 1/8 ounce (4 g).

3/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates lot average net weight is less than specified net weight.



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TABLE V. Examination for part slices

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Minor | Type I |
| 201 | More than two part slices (see 6.8) present. 1/ |
| 202 | Less than 40 whole slices (see 6.8) present. 1/ |
| | Type II |
| 203 | More than three part slices (see 6.8) present. 1/ |
| 204 | Less than 100 whole slices (see 6.8) present. 1/ |

1/ Measure linear dimension to a tolerance of 1/4 inch (6 mm) (see 5.1).

TABLE VI. Examination for product characteristics 1/ 2/

| Category | | | Defect |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major A | Major B | Minor | Type I and Type II |
| 101 | | | Presence of foreign material. 6/ |
| 102 | | | Presence of foreign or undesirable flavor. |
| | 151 | | Product does not possess a natural cooked bacon color, taste or odor. 4/ |
| | 152 | | One or more slice(s) contain a bruise(s) in excess of 1/2 inch (13 mm) in any dimension. 3/ 5/ |
| | 153 | | Slices with burnt edges or burnt areas larger than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension in excess of specified tolerance (see 3.4 and 6.8). 3/ |
| | 154 | | Slices cut or torn in excess of specified tolerance (see 3.4 and 6.8). 3/ |
| | 155 | | Brittle slices in excess of specified tolerances (see 3.4 and 6.8). |
| | 156 | | Slices containing buttons, bones or feather bones in excess of specified tolerance (see 3.4). |
| | | 201 | Slices tangled to the extent that they cannot be separated into individual slices without tearing. |

1/ The end item shall be examined at a temperature of 70° to 80°F (21° to 27°C).



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2/ The finding of one or more Major A defects shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3/ Report results to a tolerance of 1/8 inch (3 mm).

4/ Three sample units shall be utilized for determination.

5/ Each two occurrences shall be recorded as an additional defect.

6/ Within the total quantity represented by all sample units of the sample size specified, defects equal to or in excess of the foreign material tolerances specified in 6.8 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE VII. Examination of level B packaging (type II) (see 5.1.2)

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major B | Minor | |
| 151 | | Nomenclature missing, incorrect or illegible. |
| 152 | | Not material specified. |
| 153 | | Product not arranged as specified. |
| 154 | | Not sealed. |
| | 201 | Information sheet not correctly placed. |
| 155 | | Tear or hole. |
| | 202 | Information other than nomenclature, missing, incorrect or illegible on information sheet or stiffening board, as applicable. |
| 156 | | Information sheet missing when applicable. |
| 157 | | Package does not cling to product. |
| 158 | | Stiffening board missing or not positioned properly, when applicable. |
| 159 | | Evidence of package being heat processed. |

4.3.4.1 Examination of type II product at time of shipment and delivery. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.4.3 as concerns temperature. Lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container. The sample size shall be the number of shipping containers indicated by inspection level S-2. The AQL expressed as percent defective and classified as a major defect shall be 4.0. The sample unit shall be considered defective when the temperature exceeds the specified temperature.



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4.3.4.2 Examination of labeling, type I. Examination of labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497.

4.3.4.3 Examination of shipping container for level B or C pack (type II). Examination of the filled and closed shipping container for level B pack shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix of PPP-B-636 or PPP-B-1163, as applicable. In addition, the following defects shall be added: Major: (1) NSN, contract no., item description or date of pack markings; missing, incorrect or illegible. (2) Partition missing. (3) Color of reinforcing bands not as specified. Minor: (1) Number of packages not as specified. (2) Not stacked as specified. (3) Not snug-fitting. (4) Not type of partition specified. (5) Other marking requirements not as specified. Examination of level C pack shall be in accordance with the aforementioned examination criteria except that only the added defects, as applicable, and closure requirements (see 5.2.2) shall apply.

4.3.4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery of type I product. Examination of packaging, packing, marking and vacuum shall be in accordance with the applicable paragraphs and tables of PPP-C-29 and subsidiary specifications when therein directed. When level A or B packing is required to be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix to PPP-B-636, the following additional defects shall be included in the table of examination. Major: (1) NSN, contract no., item description or date of pack markings; missing, incorrect or illegible. (2) Evidence of package being heat processed. Minor: (1) Arrangement not as specified. (2) Other marking requirements not as specified. For level C pack, examination shall be in accordance with the aforementioned specification except that only the additional defects, as applicable, shall apply.

4.4 Sampling procedure and acceptance criteria for testing moisture to salt ratio (type I). The finished product shall be tested for moisture and salt content to determine compliance with moisture to salt ratio (see 3.4.2). Procedures for analytical testing shall be in accordance with 4.5.3. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent except that the moisture to salt ratio which shall be reported to the second decimal. The moisture to salt ratio shall be applicable to each unit of product. The sample unit for testing shall be the contents of one primary container. All sample units shall be randomly selected from a production lot. Each sample unit to be tested shall be drawn from a separate shipping container unless the sample size exceeds the number of shipping containers. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers. MIL-STD-414 shall be applicable except that tightened inspection shall not apply



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and the sample size shall consist of the number of sample units indicated by code letter G regardless of lot size. The AQL expressed as percent defective shall be 0.25. Acceptance of the lot shall be based on meeting the acceptability criterion of the Single Specification Limit - Form 2 - Variability Unknown - Standard Deviation Method. Failure of the lot to meet the acceptability criteria ($P_U$ less than M) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5 Examination and test procedures.

4.5.1 Examination procedures for sliced bacon yield (see 3.3.2). At the start of cooking of each lot and periodically during the cooking, but not less than four additional times, the cooked yield shall be determined. The sample for examination shall be the quantity of slices equivalent to the amount of slices derived from one bacon slab (see 3.2.1). Slices shall be randomly selected, weighed and identified. The sample slices shall be cooked in the same manner as, but without co-mingling, with production product. The cooked sample shall be drained, cooled to ambient temperature and reweighed. The weight of the cooked sample shall be not more than 40 percent of the weight of the raw sample. Each lot shall be identified and maintained in a manner approved by the supervisory Government inspector. The supplier shall prepare, sign and provide the Government Quality Assurance Representative (QAR) for approval, a report delineating sample size and sequence of procedures to determine yield. Failure of the supplier to identify, maintain lot identity, and furnish the signed report, shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Determination of compliance to the requirements of 3.3.2 shall be ascertained by the QAR. Failure to comply with one or more of the referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Records of documents shall be maintained as evidence of amount of incoming bacon, scrap bacon, and finished bacon produced under the contract. Failure of the supplier to maintain and furnish required documentation to the QAR when the alternate procedure is used shall be cause for rejection of the lot or lots involved, as applicable. When the alternate procedure is used, determination of compliance shall be ascertained by the QAR by examination of valid documents. Failure of the documents to substantiate yield requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot or lots involved, as applicable.

4.5.2 Test procedures.

4.5.2.1 Preparation. Samples shall be prepared for analysis by comminuting the entire contents of the can.



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4.5.2.2 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses of the product shall be made in accordance with the following methods from Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat:

| Test | Method |
|---|---|
| Salt | Salt |
| Moisture | Air Drying (Using drying temperature of 101° - 102°C for 16-18 hours) |

4.5.2.3 Basis weight. Basis weight shall be determined in accordance with Method 5022 of FED-STD-101.

4.5.2.4 Thickness. Thickness of plastic film shall be determined in accordance with L-P-378.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The precooked sliced bacon shall be packaged in accordance with level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A (type I). A net weight of 22 ounces (624 g) of precooked bacon slices shall be filled into a size 307 by 509-510 can in accordance with the level A requirements of PPP-C-29. No can shall contain less than 40 whole slices (see 3.3 and 6.8). No can shall contain more than two part slices (see 6.8). Alternatively a size 401 x 411 can may be used. A minus 1/4 ounce (7 g) tolerance will be allowed in any individual can provided the average net weight of the cans in the lot is not less than 22 ounces (624 g). The bacon slices shall be rolled into a neat unit using vegetable parchment or parchmentized paper, having a basis weight of not less than 26 pounds per ream ± 5 percent (24 by 36-500) (42.3 g/$m^2$) (see 4.5.3.3), prior to insertion into the can. The filled and sealed can shall have a minimum vacuum of 20 inches of mercury (33.4 kPa absolute pressure) when tested in accordance with PPP-C-29. The filled can shall not be heat processed but may be washed with hot water or steam to remove external grease.

5.1.2 Level B (type II). A net weight of 32 ounces (907 g) of precooked bacon slices shall be packaged into a flexible pouch constructed from one of the materials specified in 5.1.2.1. The slices shall be placed in the package so that the slices shall separate readily as full length or whole slices. No package shall contain less than 100 whole slices (see 3.3 and 6.8). No package shall contain more than three part slices (see 6.8). A minus 1/2 ounce (13 g) tolerance will be allowed in any individual package provided the average net weight of the pouches in the lot is not less than 32 ounces (907 g). The pouch



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shall be fabricated from one or two sheets of material heat sealed on three sides before filling. Alternatively, the pouch may be made from two webs of material, one web of which forms around the product and the other web forming the cover. The product shall be arranged in a single layer on separator sheets which shall be made from commercial grades of parchment, greaseproof or glassine paper; cellophane or polyethylene. As specified (see 6.1), the product shall either be arranged on the separator sheet shingled in the long direction such that each slice overlaps the preceding slice by not more than one-half the width of the slice or single slices of product shall be positioned flat upon the separator sheet with each slice abutting the preceding slice. Layers of product in sufficient numbers to meet package weight requirements shall be assembled in the package in a neat and orderly manner. The layers shall be positioned on a stiffening board fabricated from not less than 0.008-inch (0.203 mm) kraft or sulphite paperboard which shall be coated overall with a minimum of 0.0005-inch (0.0127 mm) thick polyethylene. Before sealing, an information sheet as specified in 5.3 shall be positioned on the surface of the product so that it may be easily read without opening the package. Alternatively, the information may be printed on the stiffening board which shall then be positioned in a manner so that the information may be read through the package wrapper. The package shall cling to the product as a result of sealing under vacuum. The filled package shall not be heat processed but may be washed with hot water or steam to remove external grease.

5.1.2.1 Packaging materials. The package shall be constructed from one of the following materials:

(a) A base material composed of not less than 0.002-inch (0.005 mm) thick polyethylene laminated to not less than 0.001-inch (0.025 mm) thick polymer-coated polyamide and a covering material composed of not less than 0.002-inch (0.005 mm) thick polyethylene laminated to not less than 0.0005-inch (0.0127 mm) thick polymer-coated polyester. Alternatively, the covering material may be the same as the base material. The polymer coating shall be not less than 0.0001-inch (0.0025 mm) thick. Thickness of plastic film shall be determined in accordance with L-P-378.

(b) A film composed of 0.0005-inch (0.0127 mm) thick polymer-coated polyester laminated to 0.002-inch (0.005 mm) thick polyethylene. The polymer coat shall be not less than 0.0001-inch (0.0025 mm) thick.

(c) A film composed of 0.002-inch (0.005 mm) thick polyethylene laminated or extruded to polymer-coated cellophane laminated to 0.0005-inch (0.0127 mm) thick biaxially oriented polypropylene with 7 pounds per ream (114 g/$m^2$) of polyethylene. The polymer coating shall be not less than 0.0001-inch (0.0025 mm) thick.



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(d) A film composed of 0.00175-inch (0.04445 mm) thick polyethylene laminated to 0.00075-inch (0.01905 mm) thick polymer-coated polypropylene. The polymer coating shall be not less than 0.0001-inch (0.0025 mm) thick. Polyionomer film may be substituted for the heat seal polyethylene film.

5.1.3 Level C (type I). The precooked sliced bacon shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 except that the can shall be in accordance with the level C requirements of PPP-C-29.

5.2 Packing. Type I product shall be packed in accordance with the level A, B or C requirements of PPP-C-29, as specified (see 6.1), except that the cans shall be arranged four in length, three in width, and two in depth. Twenty-four packages of type II product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C, as specified (see 6.1). The packages shall be arranged in stacks of twelve each, separated by full-height dividers of the same material as the shipping container.

5.2.1 Packaging, level B (type II). The shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed in accordance with style RSC-L, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container may be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box, constructed in accordance with style RSC, class 1, type SWCFI, grade 275 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of the wax-impregnated box shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black. Wax-impregnated boxes shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.1 Alternate shipping container. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.4), the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed in accordance with style RSC-L, W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated fiberboard box, constructed in accordance with style RSC, class 1, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of the wax-impregnated box shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All shipping containers shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black. Wax-impregnated boxes shall be reinforced with two lengthwise bands and one girthwise band in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Packing, level C (type II). The product shall be packed in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except that closure of fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.



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5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Type I. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. The label shall include the following information:

Precooked Bacon (Directions for use)

(1) Open can at both ends and push out bacon. (For easy removal, place closed can in hot water for a few minutes before opening.)

(2) Remove parchment and separate slices.

(3) Heat until bacon starts to crisp, 4 to 5 minutes on 350°F grill; 6 to 7 minutes in 375°F oven. Do not overcook, as bacon is fully cooked.

CONTAINS: Approximately 20 servings (2 slices per serving).

5.3.2 Type II. The following information shall be printed on a white paper sheet or stiffening board and the sheet positioned in the package as described in 5.1.2.

PRECOOKED BACON (in minimum 3/8-inch (10 mm) height letters).

Fully Cooked, Heat and Serve.
Keep Frozen or Refrigerated.
Date of Pack (Month and Year).
Name and Address of Packer.

Frozen Precooked Bacon (Directions for use)

(1) Remove bacon from freezer and slit the package to release the vacuum. Allow to stand for about 1/2 hour so that the layers may be separated for cooking.

(2) Invert each layer bacon side down on a grill or baking sheet at 350°F. Peel off paper.

(3) Heat until bacon starts to crisp, 4 to 5 minutes on 350°F grill; 6 to 7 minutes in 375°F oven. Do not overcook as bacon is fully cooked.

CONTAINS: Approximately 50 servings (2 slices per serving).



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The paper sheet, stiffening board, and printing ink used and any other information shall conform to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.3.3 Shipping containers.

5.3.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and as specified in 5.3.3.3.

5.3.3.3 Shipping container (type II). Shipping containers for type II product shall have the following precautionary statement marked on the side.

KEEP FROZEN

(0°F (-18°C) OR BELOW)

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Whether type I or II is desired (see 1.2.1).
(c) Whether a first article sample is to be furnished (see 3.1).
(d) Type of packaging required (see 5.1).
(e) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Type of packing required (see 5.2).
(g) When shipping container specified in 5.2.1.1 is required (see 6.2).
(h) When preacceptance inspection is required by Civil agencies (see 4.2.2).
(i) When a certificate of conformance is authorized (see 4.3.3.1).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7.

6.3 Plant sanitary conditions. Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.6 (also, see 4.2).



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6.4 Intended use of alternate shipping container. Packing specified in 5.2.1.1 is intended for use when experience or knowledge of the destination and mode of shipment indicates that a lower grade of board may be used.

6.5 First article. When a first article is required for inspection and approval (see 3.1, 4.1.2 and 6.6).

6.6 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The first article shall consist of 12 cans or packages. The contracting officer will include specified instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.7 Technical information. Types I and II sliced bacon described in this specification represent product stablized for extended shelf life, utilizing a relatively low moisture-to-salt ratio for type I - canned, and low temperature (0°F (-18°C) or below) storage for type II - flexible pouch. Type I product has a shelf stability of one year at 100°F (38°C). The specified cooking process which results in a product having a natural cooked bacon taste, odor and characteristic brown color serves to provide a sufficient degree of palatability which makes it possible to eat the product without the need for further preparation or reheating. Vacuum packaging of type II product reduces the tendency for the development of rancidity. Uniform maintenance of freezing temperatures at 0°F (-18°C) or below will also tend to insure against premature rancidity development. Type II product is stable for 6 months at 0°F (-18°C) or below.

6.8 Definition of terms.

6.8.1 Foreign material. Foreign material is any extraneous matter which does not organically belong where found, which has been introduced from the outside, or which does not naturally occur in the quantity found at the location examined. (APPLY ONLY FOR INSPECTION BY MILITARY VETERINARY SERVICE FOR PROCUREMENT BY THE DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE.)

a. Particles.

(1) One or more individual particles, including dust, paint chips, sawdust, and wood splinters in excess of 1/8 inch (3 mm) in greatest dimension;
(2) Smaller particles that in an aggregate cover an area of more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in diameter;
(3) One or more individual particles which are visually determined to be metal, glass or hard plastic.

b. Soft extraneous material (string, plastic wrap or tape, paper, cardboard, etc.) one or more individual pieces more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in greatest dimension.



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c. Insects. One or more insects, except that one single gnat or fruit fly is considered insignificant and is acceptable.

d. Skin (with or without hair or visible hair roots) individually or in the aggregate in excess of the area contained within a 1 inch (25 mm) square.

e. Hair and/or visible hair roots in excess of three single strands of hair or five visible hair roots or one clump of hairs or visible hair roots (strands too numerous to count) in one area.

f. Lung tissue. Any amount.

g. Stains. One or more grease stains or discoloration that individually or in aggregate covers an area more than that of a circle 1/2 inch (13 mm) in diameter.

h. Ingesta. Any amount.

i. Fecal material. Any positive identified amount.

When appropriate the final decision with respect to the interpretation of the sanitary, wholesome or esthetic significance of foreign material defects in end item shall remain with a Military veterinary officer. (This definition has been provided by the Department of the Army, Health Services Command, Ft. Sam Houston, TX 78234.)

6.8.2 Whole slices. A whole slice shall be considered any slice 5 inches (127 mm) or over in length.

6.8.3 Part slice. A part slice shall be considered any slice less than 5 inches (127 mm) in length.

6.8.4 Moisture to salt ratio. The numerical value obtained by dividing percent moisture by percent salt.

6.8.5 Burnt edge or area. A burnt edge or area is one in which the black color of carbonization is evident to the eye.

6.8.6 Brittle slices. A brittle slice is a slice which breaks or cracks if bent double at a temperature of 70°F (21°C).

6.8.7 Cut or torn slice. A cut or torn slice is one in which the cut or tear penetrates more than one-half the width of the slice.



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Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

ARGI-AMS
GSA-FSS
HEW-NIH, FDA
VA-DMS

Project No. 8905-0889

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